

Incipient among Insipids

IT'S VERY COMMON FOR PEOPLE TO TAKE A BREAK ONCE THEY ACHIEVE THEIR GOALS.

It's a lot more common for people to scale back their goals and make them more "realistic". The two put together gives us a very good picture of why people tend to give up on things so quickly. This certainly applies to all aspects in our lives be it professional relationships, personal relationships or the one that you have with yourself. This lack of discipline can quickly spiral and leave you at a disadvantage in your professional life.

In this day and age, technology acts as a fiery catalyst. If you use it well, you will catapult yourself way ahead of the curve and if you don't, you might as well start looking for alternative jobs. As a simple exercise, you can jot down all your skills that you use on a daily basis in your personal and professional life, and then figure out the ones that make you truly stand apart. If the list is long and growing, you're in the right place with the right mindset. If most of the things on that list is taken for granted by your average school graduate, then you need to reassess your skillset and figure out growth areas. I know this sounds preachy and pretentious but when you sit down and observe how quickly the technology landscape can shift then you'll be a little on edge as well. This is not to say that there won't be technology domains that are evergreen and remain unchanged for large periods of time. That will always be there but do you want to be competing in that space where you're likely to be replaced by a younger person in 5-6 years?

Coming back to the growth areas, some of these growth areas are defined by skill-deficiency whereas some are defined by upcoming technology domains that are soon to see explosive growth or have already begun to do so. We've focused on both of them in this month's cover story. A good portion of the things we've covered have been identified as skills that are deficient in the current workforce as per the Recruit-

ing Trends 2019-20 report that's published by the Michigan State University. Some of the industry leaders we've spoken to have even highlighted a few growing technology verticals that show promise over the next decade. These are not just upcoming technology domains but also things that are taken for granted by most folks.

You are very unlikely to remain in your first job for most of your career. Sometimes you will switch companies and sometimes you will switch verticals altogether. This could be purely due to interest or because the vertical that you're currently employed in is doomed to be extinct. Coming from someone involved in the print publishing industry, this is quite obvious to my colleagues and I. Needless to say, we have a few growth areas that we need to be focusing on as well. We need to be constantly learning new skills and shifting goal posts on the basis of what's happening in the industry. Learning should be an ongoing process no matter what stage of life you are in. It shouldn't stop the moment you earn your degree and secure a job. Certain skills such as coding are going to be enormously helpful no matter which domain you secure a job in. Got a set of mundane things you need to do on a daily basis? You can continue to do them day in and day out or you can write a script to automate it and move on to doing something that's actually satisfying. Who knows, you might even chance upon a niche vertical and really own that space, become an expert that the world looks up to. That's always better than being just another pawn.

With that, I'll put an end to this little self-help section and let you move on to the good stuff. As always, please do write to us at editor@digit.in with your opinions, complaints and suggestions. 



"We need to be constantly learning new skills and shifting goal posts on the basis of what's happening in the industry."



Let me know your thoughts on this column at:
[@mithun_mohandas](https://twitter.com/mithun_mohandas) |
mithun@digit.in